

Gardening with Arthritis – UK Tips & Adapted Tools

Love gardening but struggling with arthritis? UK guide to adapted tools, ergonomic techniques, and ways to enjoy your garden with less joint pain.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-01-10 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

Gardening is one of the UK's most popular hobbies, and arthritis shouldn't stop you enjoying it. With the right tools, techniques, and pacing, you can continue gardening safely and comfortably.

Benefits of Gardening with Arthritis

- Gentle exercise that improves joint flexibility and strength
 - Being outdoors boosts mood and reduces stress
 - Vitamin D from sunlight helps bone and joint health
 - Sense of achievement and purpose
 - Growing your own anti-inflammatory foods (turmeric, berries, herbs)
-

Adapted Gardening Tools



Openly licensed image via Openverse

- Ergonomic hand tools — angled handles reduce wrist strain (Radius Garden, Peta UK)
- Long-handled tools — reduce bending and kneeling (arm-length trowels, extended hoes)
- Ratchet secateurs — require 70% less grip force than standard secateurs
- Kneeling pad with handles — supports getting up and down
- Garden scooter/seal — wheeled seat for working at ground level
- Lightweight hosepipe — easier to handle than heavy rubber hoses
- Electric/battery tools — cordless hedge trimmers, lawn mowers reduce effort

Raised Bed Gardening

Raised beds are the single best adaptation for arthritis gardeners:

- Eliminate bending and kneeling
 - Can be built at waist or wheelchair height
 - Available as kits from garden centres (from £30)
 - Ideal on patios and small gardens
 - Can grow vegetables, herbs, and flowers
-

Pacing Your Gardening



Openly licensed image via Openverse

- Limit sessions to 20-30 minutes, then take a break
- Spread heavy tasks across several days
- Garden during warmer parts of the day when joints are looser

- Alternate between standing, kneeling, and sitting tasks
 - Don't try to "finish" in one session — there's always tomorrow
-

Joint-Friendly Techniques

- Use your whole body, not just your hands and wrists
 - Carry items close to your body
 - Push wheelbarrows rather than lifting
 - Use a foam grip on tool handles for extra cushioning
 - Wear gardening gloves with padding for joint protection
-

Where to Buy Adapted Garden Tools in the UK



Openly licensed image via Openverse

- Peta (UK) — specialist adaptive tools (petauk.com)
- Thrive — charity supporting therapeutic gardening
- Garden centres — most now stock ergonomic ranges
- Amazon UK — wide range of adaptive garden equipment

Gardening is excellent therapy for both body and mind. Don't give it up — adapt it to suit your abilities.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about gardening with arthritis – uk tips & adapted tools?

Short answer: Gardening with arthritis is achievable by using adapted tools and techniques. Ergonomic hand tools, long-handled tools, and ratchet secateurs reduce strain. Raised garden beds eliminate bending and kneeling. Pacing yourself by taking breaks, spreading tasks, and alternating positions also helps. Carrying items close to your body and using foam grips on tools are joint-friendly techniques to minimise discomfort.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Versus Arthritis: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk